

```
pip install docutils
```

There are several tools that come with this package, which is used to convert rst files to various other formats:

```
rst2html    rst2man      rst2pseudoxml
rst2html4   rst2odt      rst2s5
rst2html5   rst2odt_prepstyles
rst2xetex
rst2latex   rst2pdf       rst2xml
```

Sphinx, which is built on top of docutils and intended for larger projects, adds even more functionality and can be used to create very professional looking documents. Sphinx can be installed by running the following command from the terminal:

```
pip install sphinx sphinx-autobuild
```

Titles in reST

Titles are underlined (or over- and underlined) with a non-alphabetic character, which is at least as long as the text of the title. A lone top-level section is lifted up to be the document's title. Any non-alphanumeric character can be used, but the Python convention is as follows:

- # with overline, for parts
- * with overline, for chapters
- = for sections (for Heading1)
- - for sub-sections (for Heading2)
- ^ for sub-subsections (for Heading3)
- “ for paragraphs (for Heading4)

Blocks in reST

The most basic block in a reST document is 'Paragraph', which can be created by giving one or more blank lines before the text to be paragraphed.

- Inline Markup in reST is the same as in Markdown
- One asterisk: **text** for emphasis (italics)
- Two asterisks: ****text**** for strong emphasis (boldface)
- Backquotes: 'text' for code samples

Line blocks are a way of preserving line breaks, as follows:

```
| These lines are
|
| broken exactly like in
|
| the source file.
```

Doctest blocks are interactive Python sessions. They begin with '>>>' and end with a blank line. Here's an example:

```
>>> print "This is a doctest block"
This is a doctest block.
```

Lists in reST

Lists of items come in three main flavours: enumerated, bulleted and definitions. In all list cases, you may have as many paragraphs, sub-lists, etc, as you want, as long as the left-hand side of the paragraph or whatever aligns with the first line of text in the list item.

Definition lists can be created in the following format:

```
what
```

Definition lists associate a term with a definition.

```
how
```

The term is a one-line phrase and the definition is one or more paragraphs or body elements, indented relative to the term. Blank lines are not allowed between term and definition.

Metadata, like information about the author, version and dedication, can be written in the following syntax:

```
:Authors:
    David Goodger
    and pals

:Version: 1.0 of 2019/12/01

:Dedication: To all free software folks
```

Tables in reST

There are two syntaxes for tables in reStructuredText. Grid tables are complete but cumbersome to create. Simple tables are easy to create but with limited functionality (no row spans, etc). A grid table example is given below:

```
+-----+-----+-----+
| Header 1 | Header 2 | Header 3 |
+-----+-----+-----+
| body row 1 | column 2 | column 3 |
+-----+-----+-----+
| body row 2 | Cells may span columns. |
+-----+-----+-----+
| body row 3 | Cells may | - Cells |
+-----+ span rows. | - contain |
| body row 4 | | - blocks. |
+-----+-----+-----+
```

The result is:

Header 1	Header 2	Header 3
body row 1	column 2	column 3
body row 2	Cells may span columns.	
body row 3	Cells may span rows.	• Cells contain blocks.
body row 4		

An example of a simple table is given below:

```
====  =====
Inputs    Output
-----
A      B    A or B
=====
False  False False
True   False True
False  True  True
True   True  True
=====
```

The result is:

Inputs		Output
A	B	A or B
False	False	False
True	False	True
False	True	True
True	True	True